

UTT Chapter 07 Assignment

Hi there!

It's only eight p.m. here, but I'm so tired already! Some of the guys in my dorm decided it would be a fun prank to pull the fire alarm every night at two a.m. *Not* fun. Everyone has to leave the building even during false alarms, and it usually takes around half an hour for the firemen to check everything. I'm. So. Tired! They somehow haven't caught the perpetrators; it seems like they pull the alarm on different floors every night. I hope it stops soon.

Anyway, it's been a good week other than that. Nothing too eventful has happened, and I haven't had much homework, which is always nice. I had to write a big paper for my art class this week, which was fun since I wrote about the impressionists. I've always enjoyed their art. We're moving through the romantic period all the way up to the present. This week we studied postmodern art. I'm not sure how I feel about it. At first I wasn't impressed, but I think I'm warming up to some of the works. Postmodern art is basically a reaction to modern art, which was all about structure and getting down to the foundations of art itself—stripping away everything that distracts from the main message of the piece. Postmodern art challenges the very definition of art itself. A lot of artists just put junk on a pedestal and call it art. One guy even took a urinal, signed it, and called it "Fountain." Seems kind of disgusting to me, but it's displayed in a museum somewhere. I guess if it gets people talking, then that's something.

Paige, a friend of mine from class, is really into postmodern art. She says that labels and definitions for things that are "art" and things that are "junk" are just that—labels. Everything is sacred, and nothing is sacred. She believes that since reality is fragmented and chaotic, art should display the same attitude. Since there's no definition of what makes us human, or what makes a thing a "thing," art should reflect this. My head is spinning just trying to make sense of everything!

I guess Postmodernism isn't just about art. After class, Paige told me a little bit about Postmodernism. I guess it's a worldview, or at least she made it seem that way. I was able to follow a little of what she said, but I must admit, I was mostly lost. **What is Postmodernism?** She apparently doesn't believe in human nature, but I'm not sure how to even make sense of that. **What does Postmodernism say about humanity?** I'm guessing that Postmodernism doesn't believe in the fall, so **what does Postmodernism say is wrong with us?** Sadly, we didn't get a chance to talk about ethics at all. **What does Postmodernism say about how we should live?** From the way Paige was talking, I wouldn't be surprised if you couldn't answer these questions in a way that makes sense. It doesn't seem like anything she said was coherent!

Once again, thanks for your help! You're the best worldview dictionary a friend can have.

Talk to you later!

–Doug